

SPORTS WORLD

By Harold U. Ribalow

Baseball Expansion

This is the hot-stove season, so it is perfectly all right for a writer to discuss baseball, even though we are still in the football and basketball season and we are all involved, in one way or another, in a new Kennedy Administration in the sense that we have been following Kennedy's selections for his "team."

But back to baseball: with the American and National Leagues both expanding, the name of Hank Greenberg keeps popping up in all diamond conversation. While still a vice-president and stockholder in the Chicago White Sox, Hank made it clear, almost as soon as AL expansion was announced, that he wanted to head a club in Los Angeles. He talked with all sorts of officials of the Coliseum and the minor league clubs in the area and made it plain that he expected to get out of the White Sox situation and become a leader in the new Los Angeles club. It was obvious that no matter how long the planning phase took, Greenberg would be part and parcel of a new team. Greenberg feels that he was confident a team could be organized for the 1961 season but he wasn't sure how long it would take to get together a squad good enough to win a pennant.

There is no question that Hank Greenberg, one of the great sluggers of all time, and perhaps the finest Jewish player in the history of the game (with Al Rosen running him a close second, or neck-and-neck), was going to go down in the annals of the sport as a major Jewish executive as well.

Small Matters

With the baseball season over and the football season at its peak and the professional hoop league getting into gear, we have a few small matters to deal with, for the record and for those who like to keep up with just about everything.

Yeshiva University has a wrestling team, as well as teams in other minor — and some major — sports. This year, the Yeshiva boys, humorously called "The Mighty Mites," will — how do you put it? — meet, or wrestle, against ten opponents, opening with a match versus Montclair State College on Dec. 7. The Yeshiva lads are coached by Henry Wittenberg, one of the genuinely great wrestlers of our time and a former Olympic champion.

The Sixth Maccabiah Games in Israel will be held from Aug. 29 to

Sept. 6, and arrangements are already under way in the United States for American representation. Chairman of the U. S. Maccabiah Games Committee is M. J. Lowell, who was chairman of the 1957 Games in Tel Aviv, chairman, that is, of the U. S. track and field team. Mr. Lowell declared that he expected to get together a squad of 100 male and female athletes in the forthcoming Games. Lowell himself was a track man at Columbia and a member of many U. S. Olympic Committees.

Wally Moses

When the New York Yankees struck down the genial Casey Stengel because he was "too old," they named Ralph Houk as the new Yankee manager. Houk, an aggressive and independent sort of man, announced almost immediately that he was going to get some of his own coaches for the club. So he dropped Eddie Lopat as pitching mentor and signed up Johnny Sain. And then he hired Wally Moses. Moses is not Jewish and thereby hangs a tale.

Wally had a lifetime batting average of .291 and was a veteran by the time his career was over. He had played in the outfield for the Philadelphia Athletics and the Chicago White Sox and the Boston Red Sox. Not spectacular, he was consistent and he was also good.

Moses had been good, too, in the minor leagues. At that time, John McGraw of the New York Giants, wanted a sparkling Jewish player to win over Jewish fans to the Giants. He remembered how Jews came to watch Andy Cohen and the feeling was that a Jewish star would be a big box office attraction. Because of his name, Moses was thought to be a Jew. But he admitted that he wasn't. So McGraw didn't want him. As a result, Wally hung around in the minors long after he deserved to be in the big leagues. Eventually, he came to Philadelphia, and he was one of the few players in the game of whom it could be said that he was kept in the minors because he was not a Jew! Quite a twist. This story has been told before in my book, "The Jew in American Sports." But because Moses is in the news again, I think it is worth retelling.

French Shipyard Strike Prevents the Launching of Israeli Ship

PARIS — (JTA) — A launching